

Ms Rachel E Dickon
Assistant Secretary
Federal Maritime Commission
800 North Capitol Street, NW
Washington, DC 20573-0001

January 25, 2018

Subject: Docket 17-10, Comments on Proposed NSA/NRA Regulations

Dear Assistant Secretary Dickon,

My name is *Robin Ashwood*, with *Crescent Products USA LLC* located in Washington, DC. *Crescent Products USA LLC*, and myself specifically, are involved with the international shipping of our products and supplies. We regularly use the services of freight forwarders and NVOCC's to facilitate the movement of our shipments both for import and export purposes.

Crescent Products USA LLC negotiates service and rates directly with the freight forwarders and NVOCCs it uses. We do not rely on published tariffs when deciding which NVOCC or freight forwarder to use. Furthermore, it is our preference to be able to negotiate these services, not just the rates, without being required to have a formal written contract that needs to be filed with the Federal Maritime Commission (FMC.)

In our view, filing negotiated contracts/rates are a regulatory requirement that serves no real purpose but simply adds time and administrative costs to process. We do not need the government to supervise our commercial arrangement with our forwarders or NVOCCs. If we are displeased with the service or rates provided by our forwarders/NVOCCs then we address that topic with them directly just like we do if we have a difference with our customers or other suppliers.

Thank you the Federal Maritime Commission for considering our views and for working towards a solution that will reduce costs and ease regulatory burdens for both shippers and forwarders/NVOCCs.



3050 K street NW, Suite 170
Washington, DC 20007

A handwritten signature in black ink, appearing to read 'Robin Ashwood', with a long horizontal flourish extending to the right.

Robin Ashwood
Crescent Products USA, LLC
3050 K Street
Washington, DC 20007